

Foundations of Child Protection

Learner guide | SWP-001 | School of Child & Family Welfare

This guide supports a three-part learning sequence for Foundations of Child Protection. By the end of the course, you should be able to recognise protection concerns, respond safely, and follow the local reporting pathway.

Practice notice: Apply the law, organisational policy, supervision requirements, and approved referral pathways that govern your setting. This material supports learning and does not replace urgent safeguarding, clinical, or legal procedures.

Learning objectives

- Recognise protection concerns, respond safely, and follow the local reporting pathway.
- Apply the key ideas from Child protection foundations.
- Apply the key ideas from Recognising and responding.
- Apply the key ideas from Reporting and case coordination.

Course structure

Module	Focus	Suggested study time
1. Child protection foundations	child rights, safeguarding principles, roles, and the distinction between concern, risk, and harm	10 to 15 minutes
2. Recognising and responding	indicators of abuse/neglect, trauma-informed communication, documentation, immediate safety, and boundaries	10 to 15 minutes
3. Reporting and case coordination	mandated reporting, referral pathways, confidentiality limits, multi-agency coordination, and reflective case scenario	10 to 15 minutes

Module 1 Child protection foundations

This module focuses on child rights, safeguarding principles, roles, and the distinction between concern, risk, and harm. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Child rights
- Safeguarding principles
- Roles
- The distinction between concern
- Risk
- Harm

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of child protection foundations in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of child rights, safeguarding principles, roles, and the distinction between concern, risk, and harm. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through child protection foundations safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 2 Recognising and responding

This module focuses on indicators of abuse/neglect, trauma-informed communication, documentation, immediate safety, and boundaries. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Indicators of abuse/neglect
- Trauma-informed communication
- Documentation
- Immediate safety
- Boundaries

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of recognising and responding in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of indicators of abuse/neglect, trauma-informed communication, documentation, immediate safety, and boundaries. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through recognising and responding safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Module 3 Reporting and case coordination

This module focuses on mandated reporting, referral pathways, confidentiality limits, multi-agency coordination, and reflective case scenario. Work through the material with a current practice setting in mind, but remove identifying information from any examples you record.

What to pay attention to

- Mandated reporting
- Referral pathways
- Confidentiality limits
- Multi-agency coordination
- Reflective case scenario

Learning sequence

Start by defining the purpose of reporting and case coordination in relation to the course outcome. Notice where professional judgement is needed and where a local procedure must guide the next step.

Examine the practical implications of mandated reporting, referral pathways, confidentiality limits, multi-agency coordination, and reflective case scenario. Separate observations from assumptions, identify strengths as well as concerns, and be clear about information that must be checked with a person, family, colleague, or approved source.

Use a respectful, collaborative approach. Explain your role, seek informed participation where appropriate, and document only information that is relevant, accurate, and necessary for the purpose of the work.

When a concern exceeds your role, supervision, competence, or authority, pause and use the correct escalation route. A prompt referral and a clear handover can protect continuity of support.

Practice reflection

Choose a de-identified practice situation. What information would help you work through reporting and case coordination safely, and what would require consultation or a local policy check?

Course activity

Use the accompanying worksheet to apply the course sequence to a short case. Your completed activity should show what you noticed, the action you would take within your role, and what you would escalate or verify locally.

Assessment preparation

- Review the distinction between: recognition.
- Review the distinction between: first response.
- Review the distinction between: documentation.
- Review the distinction between: referral.
- Review the distinction between: ethics.

References and local adaptation

- SWEEP Academy Course Content Outlines, production blueprint for this course.
- The current legislation, professional standards, safeguarding procedures, and referral directories for the delivery jurisdiction.
- The learner's employer or placement policy, supervision arrangements, and documentation standards.